JAMES PIERPONT

JINGLE BELLS

arranged for percussion ensemble
by Eric Esquivel



Jingle Bells arranged by Eric Esquivel
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PROGRAM NOTES

Originally composed by James Lord Pierpont and published in 1857 as "The One Horse Open Sleigh," *Jingle Bells* has become a holiday classic. Though not originally linked to Christmas, its association with the holiday grew in the late 19th century, with its popularity solidified by early 20th century recordings.

This arrangement was created to meet the needs of a large beginner percussion ensemble. With limited existing repertoire for this skill level, I crafted an arrangement of *Jingle Bells* that emphasized simple rhythms and patterns while accommodating the diverse abilities of the original twelve students that performed the piece. The arrangement utilizes mallet keyboards, snare and bass drums, timpani, and sleigh bells.

—Eric Esquivel

PERFORMANCE NOTES

This arrangement of *Jingle Bells* is in simple ABA form. Note the dynamic changes in each section; each subsequent phrase is a dynamic level louder than the first phrase, and when the A section returns, it is a level louder than the first A section.

Instrumentation and part assignments:

- Mallet/keyboard percussion (in B♭ major): Place your strongest players on these parts due to their active role. The range spans a full octave with one accidental (E-natural).

  Glockenspiel carries the main melody throughout.

  Xylophone and marimba 1 primarily play the melody. During the A sections, xylophone and marimba 1 trade back and forth between melody and harmony. During the B section, both parts remain on melody, doubling the glockenspiel.

  Marimba 2 functions as the "support marimba" by playing the same rhythm as the melody but as harmonic support.

  Marimba 3, referred to as the "bass marimba," provides the foundation (along with timpani) for the pitched instruments. Utilizing the lower register of a 4.3-octave marimba, this player may share a marimba with marimba 2.

- Timpani: Scored for four drums with stationary pitches (no tuning changes required), this part supports the marimba 3 part. If your school/organization does not have timpani, you may omit this part.

- Snare drum and bass drum: These parts feature repetitive rhythmic patterns. Assign your best timekeepers to these roles for precise execution.

- Any and all parts may be doubled or tripled to accommodate for larger ensembles.

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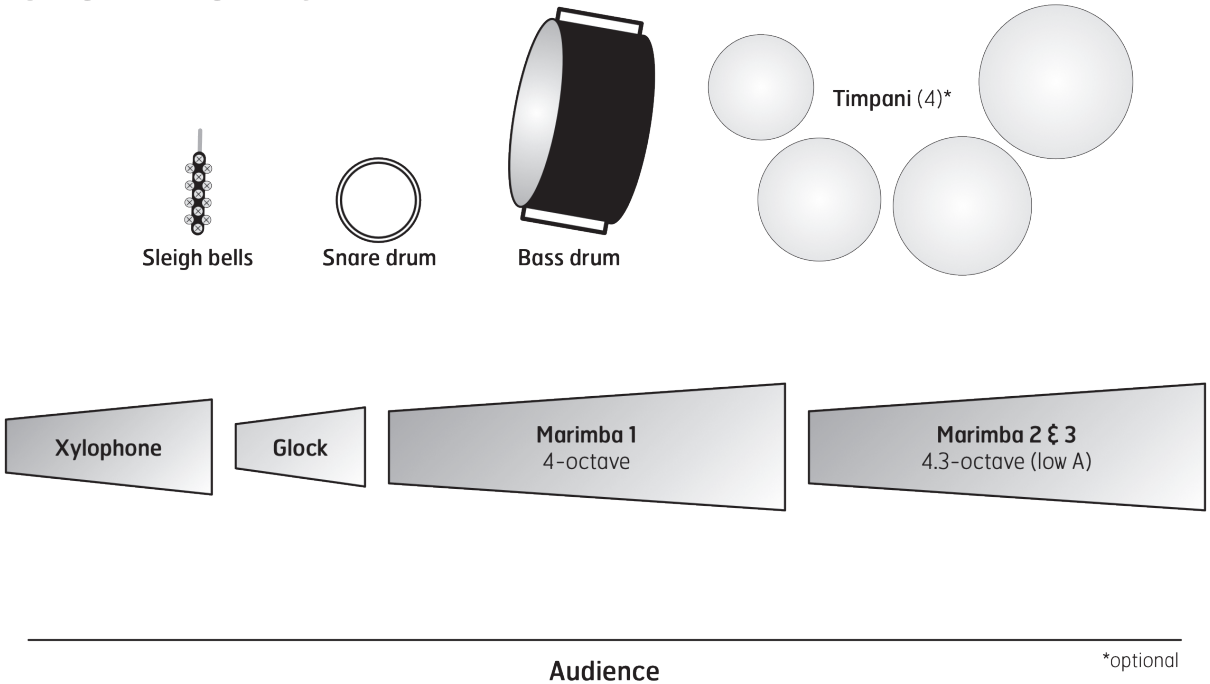
PLAYERS AND INSTRUMENTATION

Jingle Bells requires **8–9+ players** with the following instrumentation:

1. **Glockenspiel**
2. **Xylophone**
3. **Marimba 1** (4-octave)
4. **Marimba 2** (share w/ M3)
5. **Marimba 3** (low A)
6. **4 Timpani*** (32", 29", 26", 23")
7. **Snare drum**
8. **Bass drum**
9. **Sleigh bells**

***optional**

SUGGESTED SETUP



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Level: Easy
Approx. playing time: 2'00"

Written for the 2023-2024 Don Haskins PK–8 Beginner Percussion Ensemble

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